

EDUCATION	University of California, San Diego (UCSD), La Jolla, CA Summa Cum Laude B.S., <i>Clinical Psychology, with Distinction in Honors</i> • Advisor: Dr. Dawn Schiehser • Honors Thesis: <i>Automated Mild Cognitive Impairment Detection (PD-MCIx) in patients with Parkinson's Disease</i>	Sep 2021 – June 2025 cGPA: 3.99 / 4.00
PUBLICATIONS	B.S., <i>Cognitive Science with a Specialization in Cognitive Behavioral Neuroscience</i> 1. Adler, J., Xie, C., Schiehser, D. Progression of Cognitive Decline in Individuals with Parkinson's Disease. <i>Manuscript in Prep</i>, 2025. 2. Xie, C., Gitelman, D., Adler, J., Schiehser, D. Automated Mild Cognitive Impairment Detection (PD-MCIx) in patients with Parkinson's Disease. <i>Manuscript in Prep</i>, 2025 3. Schiehser, D., Xie, C., Adler, J., Lin, A. Mindfulness Based Stress Reduction (MBSR) for Cognitive Improvement in Parkinson's disease: A Longitudinal Randomized Controlled Trial. <i>Manuscript in Prep</i>, 2025 4. Xie, C., Mao, Y., Park, A., Geller, E. Memory and Emotion: How Prior Emotional Facial Expressions Affect Our First Impression of Niceness. <i>Journal of Undergraduate Psychological Research</i>, 2024.	
POSTERS	1. Xie, C. Chen, E., Adler, J., Carillo, A., Lin, A., Longardner, K., Schiehser, D. Cognitive Diagnostic Categorization of Parkinson's Disease patients with and without Traumatic Brain Injury. *Presidential Poster Session. <i>American Geriatric Society (AGS) Annual Meeting, Journal of the American Geriatrics Society</i>, 73(S1), S112. https://doi.org/10.1111/jgs.19450, Chicago, IL, 2025. 2. Dong, Y., Hung, Y., Xie, C., Kiyonaga, A. Testing the flexibility of pupillary working memory signals to visual and semantic task demands. <i>Vision Sciences Society (VSS) Annual Meeting, Journal of Vision</i>, 25(9), 2871. https://doi.org/10.1167/jov.25.9.2871, St. Pete Beach, FL, 2025 3. Xie, C., Gitelman, D., Adler, J., Schiehser, D. Automated Mild Cognitive Impairment Detection (PD-MCIx) in patients with Parkinson's Disease. <i>Accepted for presentation at Society for Neuroscience</i>, San Diego, CA, 2025 4. Xie, C., Geller, E. Relationships Between Sexual Orientation, State Political Affiliation, and Sex Drive. <i>Honors Poster Session</i>, San Diego, CA, 2024.	
PROFESSIONAL TALKS	1. Xie, C., Gitelman, D., Adler, J., Schiehser, D. Automated Mild Cognitive Impairment Detection (PD-MCIx) in patients with Parkinson's Disease. <i>Undergraduate Research Conference</i>, San Diego, CA, 2025 2. Adler, J., Xie, C., Schiehser, D. TBI+: The Interplay of TBI and Neurodegenerative Disease. <i>Center of Excellence for Stress and Mental Health</i>, Virtual, 2025	
OTHER PROJECTS	1. Xie, C., Ganis and Kievit Mental Rotation Replication Study. <i>GitHub Repository</i>, 2024. 2. Dong, Y., Xie, C., Kiyonaga, A. Testing the Flexibility of Pupillary Near Response in Working Memory. <i>in Prep</i>, 2025.	

RESEARCH
EXPERIENCE

**CNS Laboratory of Memory and Brain Research Assistant
(WOC) | VA San Diego Healthcare**

July 2025 - Present

Advisors: Christine Smith, Ph.D., Associate Professor of Psychiatry; Lisa Delano-Wood, Ph.D., Professor of Psychiatry

- Scoring of neuropsychological assessments (TOMM, BVMT, D-KEFS, RUFF, WMS-IV, WRAT-4, CVLT-II, WCST-64, WAIS, NAB, MINS) to examine novel cognitive and neuroimaging white matter measures in Veterans with or without mild TBI.
- Managed telephone screening and eligibility assessment, obtained informed consent, and facilitated remote enrollment for participants.

**Neurocognition and Movement Lab Research Assistant
(WOC) | VA San Diego Healthcare**

March 2024 - Present

Advisor: Dawn Schiehser, Ph.D., Professor of Psychiatry

- Assessed cognitive effects of mild to moderate traumatic brain injury (TBI) in individuals with Parkinson's disease (PD) (PD-TBI) through administration and scoring of neuropsychological tests (WMS-IV, CVLT-II, DOT-A, CWIT, DKEFS Verbal Fluency, JLOT-O, BNT-15) following strict protocols.
- Assisted with fMRI data collection; safety and operator trained on the Siemens Prisma scanner.
- Managed data cleaning and preprocessing for three large-scale longitudinal research datasets.
- Developed an Advanced Auto-Diagnosis Script for Mild Cognitive Impairment Detection.
- Adapted a imputation calculator to estimate missing scores on the UPDRS Part 3 (motor symptoms) for data cleaning.

**Kiyonaga Cognitive Neuroscience Lab Research Assistant
| UC San Diego Department of Cognitive Science**

Sep 2023 - Present

Advisors: Anastasia Kiyonaga, Ph.D., Professor of Cognitive Science; Yueying Dong, Ph.D. candidate

- Designing and conducting 3+ eye tracking experiments centered on Visual Working Memory, aimed at investigating the presence and specificity of the Pupillary Near Response in young adults with normal cognition.
- Conducted eye tracking experiments focused on internally-prioritized Working Memory content, to understand the flexibility and specificity of the Pupillary Light Response in experiments involving 100+ young adults with normal cognition.
- 30+ presentations in Journal Club about how to utilize novel research in working memory, gaze, and pupillometry.
- 4+ programming/ coding projects to understand Pupil Processing Pipeline in Python.

CDC Community Liaison

| UC San Diego Department of Global Health

Sep 2023 - Feb 2024

Advisor: Mor Shilon, Ph.D., Professor of Urban Planning

- Interviewed 300+ residents of Logan Heights and the Logan Heights CDC to assess priorities for allocating state funding towards community issues through in-person interviews.
- Assisted in the production of a community film, art show, and awareness campaign.

LAB AFFILIATIONS	Language and Infant Learning Lab UC San Diego Department of Cognitive Science March - Present Professor: Martin Zettersten, Ph.D., Assistant Professor of Cognitive Science
	Brady Lab UC San Diego Department of Psychology Jan - July 2025 Professor: Timothy Brady, Ph.D., Professor of Psychology
TEACHING EXPERIENCE	Undergraduate Instructional Assistant UC San Diego PSYC 101: Developmental Psychology Sep - Dec 2023 Professor: Gail Heyman, Ph.D., Professor of Psychology - Led 10+ weekly, midterm, and final review sessions. Conducted personalized one-on-one sessions with 10+ students who were unable to attend live lectures. - Received unanimous student recommendations in course feedback surveys in the upper-division course.
	Undergraduate Instructional Assistant UC San Diego PSYC 102: Sensory Neuroscience Sep - Dec 2024 Professor: Nirelia Morantron, Ph.D., Adjunct Professor of Psychology - Held weekly office hours and 5 exam review sessions for 200 students. - Delivered a 1.5 hour lecture on the Anatomy of the Ear and Audition.
MENTORSHIP	UC San Diego - Mira Mateo, <i>Undergraduate Student</i> 2024 – Present - German Lopez, <i>Transfer Student</i> 2024 – Present - Prisha Desai, <i>Research Assistant</i> 2025 – Present - Amy Nguyen, <i>Research Assistant</i> 2025 – Present - Soobin Jones, <i>Honors Student</i> 2024 – 25
PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS	Student Member, International Parkinson and Movement Disorder Society Student Member, American Geriatric Society Student Member, Society for Neuroscience
SKILLS	Programming: R, SPSS, Python, JavaScript, HTML, MATLAB Libraries and Apps: PANDAS, Tidyverse, Haven, dplyr, ggplot2, MICE Psychophysics: Eye-Tracking Software (Eyelink), Psychopy, jsPsych Imaging Tools: Functional Magnetic Resonance Imaging (fMRI), Electroencephalogram (EEG) Assessment: BNT-15, D-KEFS, WAIS-IV, WMS-III, WMS-IV, MDRS, DOT-A, CVLT-II, JLOT-O, CWIT, RUFF, TOMM, BVMT, WRAT-4, WCST-64, WAIS, NAB, MINS Languages: English, Cantonese, Mandarin Miscellaneous: RedCAP, Soldering, Adobe Photoshop, Arduino, Advanced Statistical Methods, VA Safety Trained
AWARDS	- Distinguished Undergraduate Researcher Award, UC San Diego 2025 - Phi Beta Kappa 2025 - Anderson Research Travel Award 2025 - Thurgood Marshall Travel Award 2024 - Provost Honors, UC San Diego 2021-2025